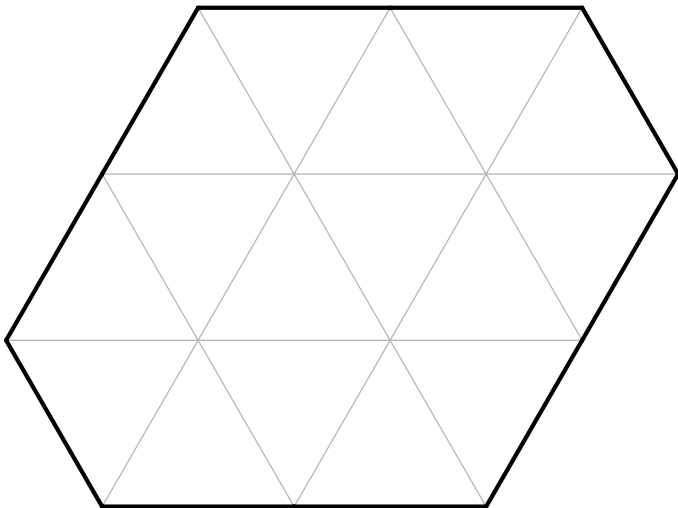
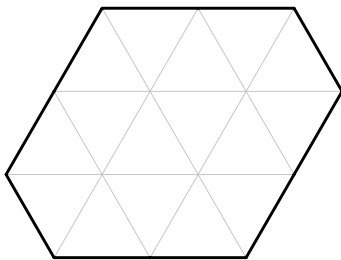


In every problem, boards are covered with blue blocks only, with no gaps and no overlaps. The small drawings of boards are for recording.

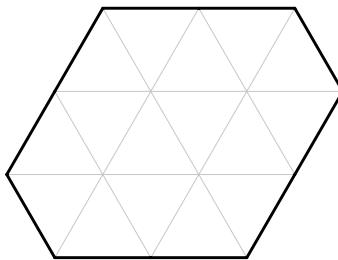
Problem 1: Cover this board with blue blocks. Find every different way to do it, and draw each way in one of the small copies below. Explain how you know that you have found them all.



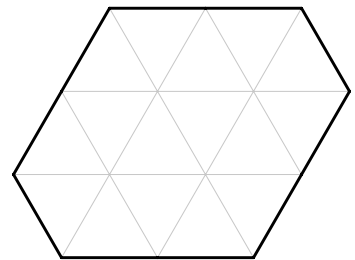
A



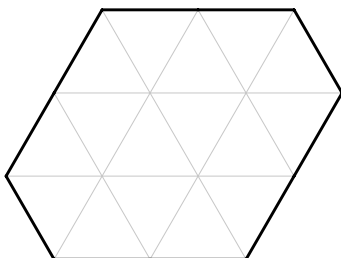
B



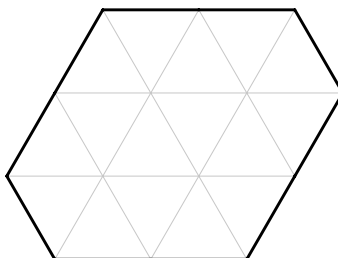
C



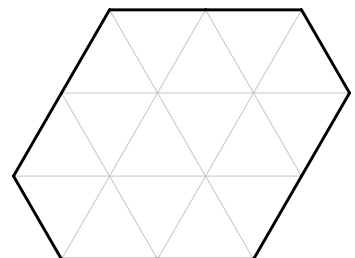
D



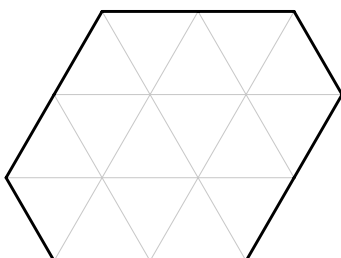
E



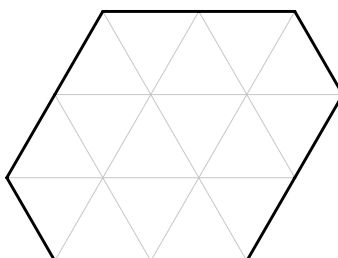
F



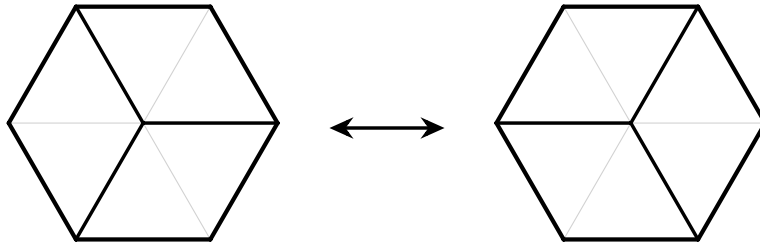
G



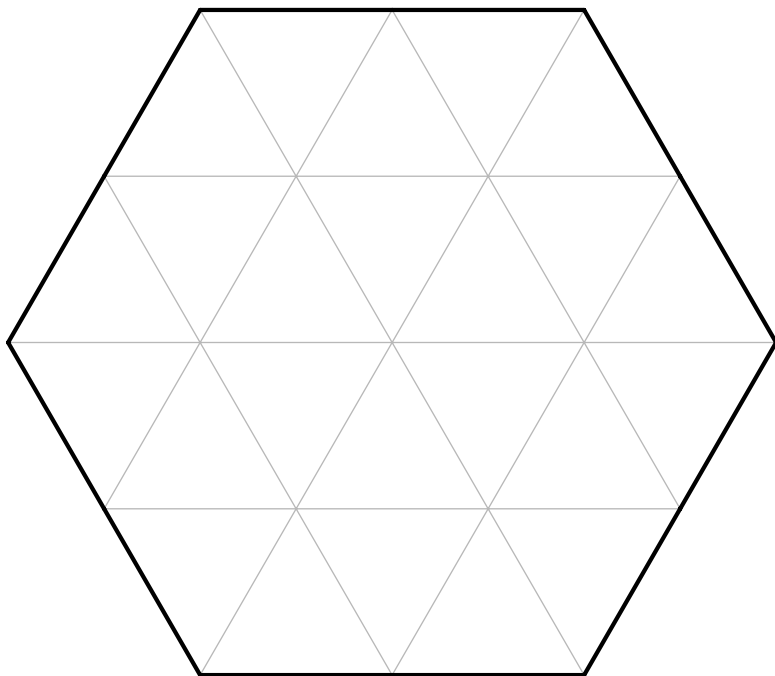
H



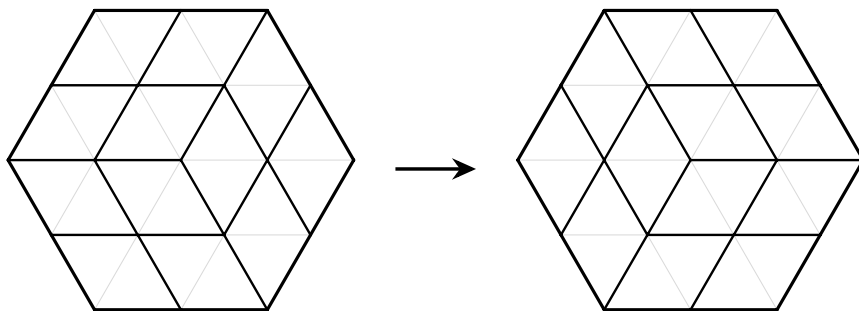
Problem 2: When three blue blocks form a hexagon the shape of a yellow block, you may lift them and put them back the other way, as in the picture. This is one move. In the box, write the letters of your coverings from Problem 1, and draw a line between two letters whenever one move changes one covering into the other.



Problem 3: Build the first covering of each pair on the big hexagon board below, then change it into the second covering using moves. Use as few moves as you can, and write how many you used. For the first pair, explain why it cannot be done in fewer moves.

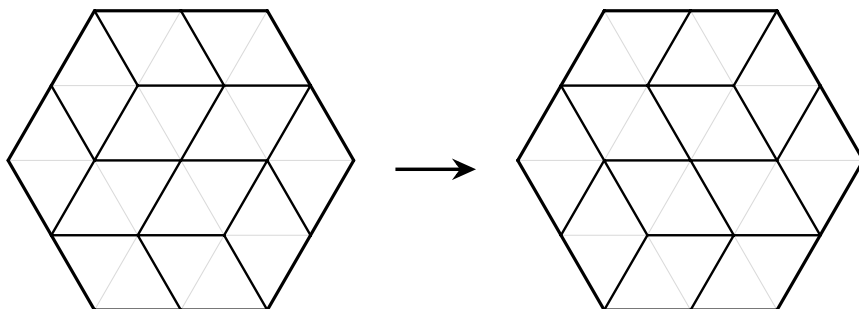


1



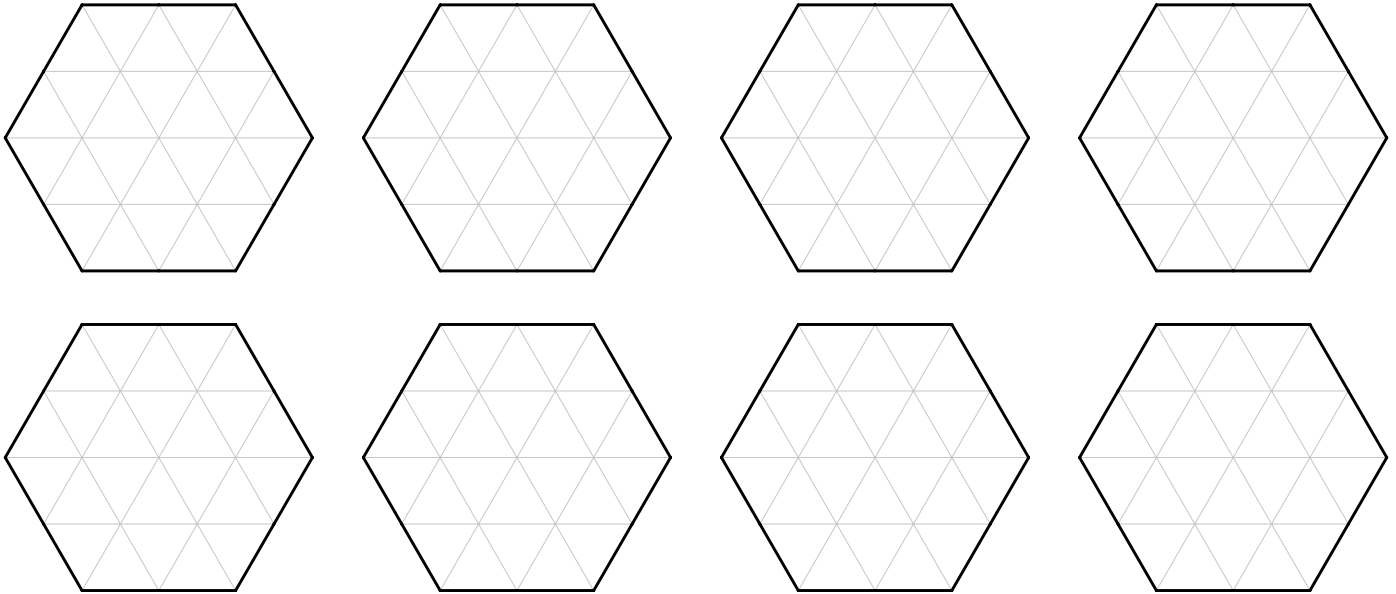
moves: _____

2

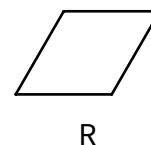
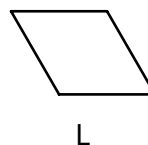
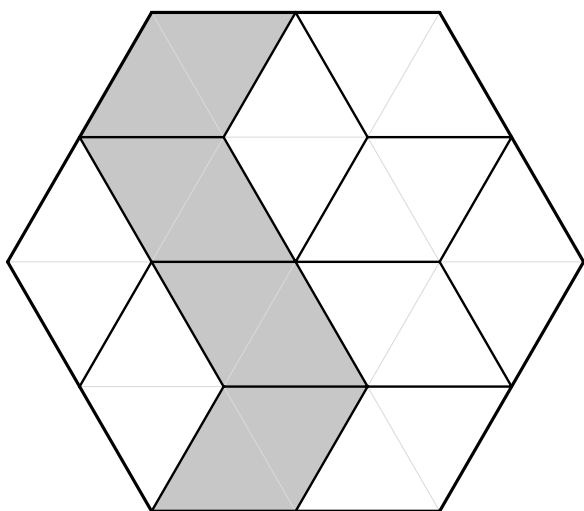


moves: _____

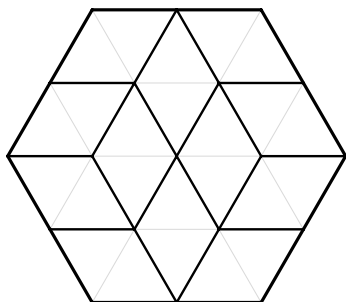
Problem 4: Start with any covering of the big hexagon and make moves until you are back at the covering you started with. No move may undo the move just before it. Can this be done in exactly 4 moves? In 5? In 6? In 7? For each number, draw the coverings you pass through, or explain why it cannot be done.



Problem 5: The bottom side of the big hexagon has two small edges. In any covering, start with the block sitting on one of these edges, then take the block sitting on its top edge, and keep going until you reach the top side of the board. These blocks form a chain. Each block in a chain leans left (L) or right (R), so a chain can be written as letters from bottom to top. In the picture, the left chain is shaded, and it is RLLR. Write both chains for each covering below.



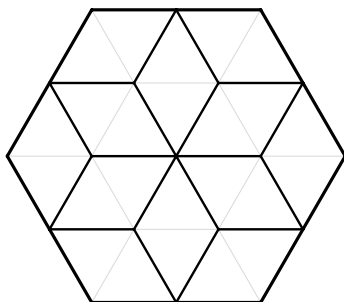
A



left chain: _____

right chain: _____

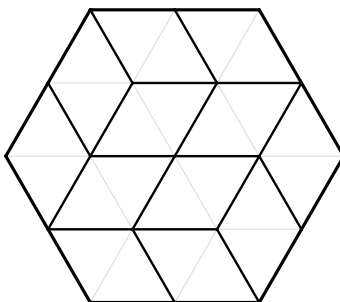
B



left chain: _____

right chain: _____

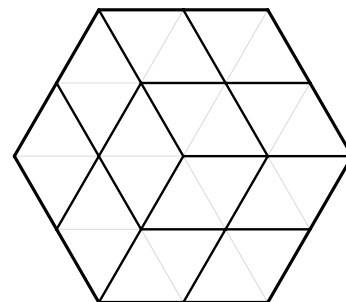
C



left chain: _____

right chain: _____

D

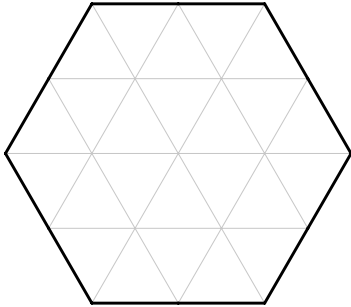


left chain: _____

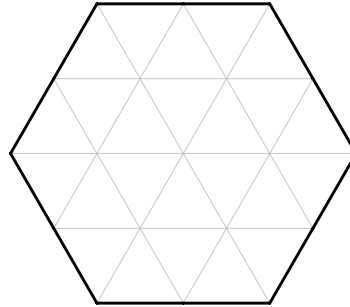
right chain: _____

Problem 6: For each pair of chains below, draw a covering of the big hexagon that has this left chain and this right chain, or explain why there is no such covering.

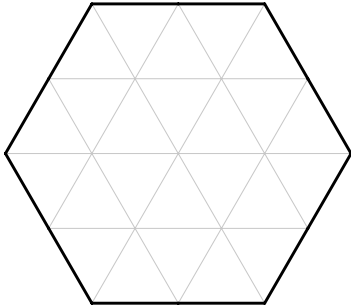
left chain LRLR, right chain RRLL



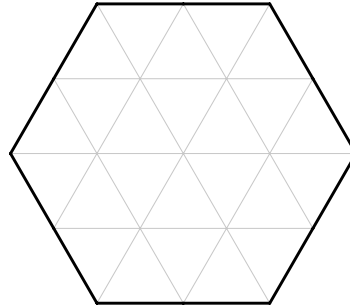
left chain RRLL, right chain LLRR



left chain RLRL, right chain RLRL

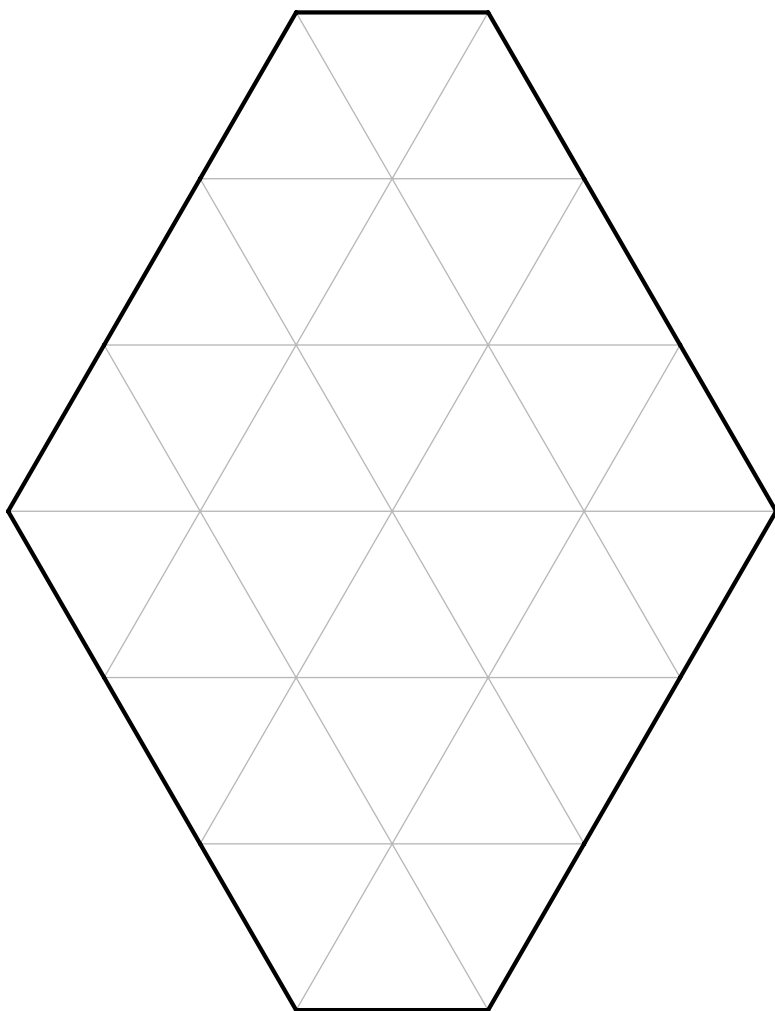


left chain LRRL, right chain LRLR



Problem 7: When you make one move on a covering of the big hexagon, how can its chains change? Explain why a move always changes the chains in this way.

Problem 8: This board has only one small edge on its bottom side. How many different ways can it be covered with blue blocks? Explain how you know that you have counted every way.



Problem 9: How many different ways can the big hexagon be covered with blue blocks? Explain how you know that you have counted every way. If you run out of copies, you can draw more on the back.

